



OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · TEACHER MANUAL

M/J Music Theory 2

Florida Course #1300010 · Grades 6–8 · Full Year · 37 Modules · On-Demand (Asynchronous)

0. How to Use This Manual

This manual documents the M/J Music Theory 2 course **as it was actually built** — every module count, tier ratio, rubric, and standard below is read from the finished build at MJMusicTheory2\04_Final\Semester 1 and Semester 2, not assumed. Where the build has a genuine gap, this manual says so plainly rather than inventing a fix — two such gaps surfaced during this audit and are flagged in bold below and in full in Sections 3 and 11. This is a facilitator-only document: it holds rubrics, answer-key structure, and internal standards codes that must never be shown to students, and it should never be published to the student-facing Canvas course.

One build gap remains open (see Section 3): no lesson in the entire 37-module course contains an AI-awareness callout, unlike other Optima courses. Not yet corrected as of this revision.

Standards gap — corrective pass applied 2026-07-14 (see Section 11 for full detail): the original audit found only 9 of 32 official Florida standards covered anywhere in the course, 6 invalid/nonexistent codes cited repeatedly (worst: "MU.68.S.1.1," used in 24 of 37 modules — it does not exist), and fabricated benchmark descriptions attached even to valid codes. A corrective pass — new required audio submissions in every composition module, two discussions rewritten as genuine interdisciplinary forums, a new reading/reflection block in Module 37, aural-identification quiz items in two modules, and code corrections in the touched modules — raised real coverage to 30 of 32 official standards. This pass touched Modules 12, 16, 17, 19, 21, 23, 26, 28, 30, 32, 34, 35, 36, and 37 specifically; modules not on that list may still carry the same invalid codes and fabricated descriptions from the original build. See Section 11 for the current map and the two still-open items.

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1. How This Course Works

A typical lesson

Every module pairs one interactive lesson page (GitHub-hosted, embedded in Canvas as "Mark as Done," no grade) with a set of Canvas-native graded items. A typical lesson opens with a CSS/SVG visual (a scale ladder, a voice-leading staff, a form diagram) before any prose, walks through the concept in short blocks tied to a specific Open Music Theory (OMT) page reference, and closes with one or two self-checking widgets (rotating between reflection prompts, flip cards, and multiple-choice rows) that give the student instant feedback and cost the teacher nothing to grade.

A typical week (~80 minutes)

Segment	What the student does	Graded?	Tier
Intro wrapper	Canvas survey quiz: essential question, objectives acknowledgment, confidence rating	Ungraded (completion)	4
Interactive lesson	GitHub-hosted page with CSS/SVG visuals + 1–2 self-checking widgets	Mark-as-done only	1
Practice / theory check	Auto-graded Canvas quiz, unlimited attempts	Yes, auto-graded	1
Discussion	Structured prompt + one reply to a classmate	Yes, completion-scored	2
Outro wrapper	Canvas survey quiz: revised answer, confidence rating, plan for next steps	Ungraded (completion)	4

Nine of the 37 modules also carry a quarterly major assessment (see below) in place of, or alongside, the usual practice quiz.

Major assessments

Quarter / Module	Assessment	Weight	What it covers
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Q1 · Module 9	Minor Keys, Modes, and Modal Mixture Assessment	~20% of Q1	Minor scale writing, modal ID, voice leading, borrowed-chord analysis, 4-measure SATB harmonization
Q2 · Module 18	Counterpoint, Form, and Jazz Assessment	~20% of Q2	Species counterpoint, classical form ID, jazz harmony analysis
Q3 · Module 27	Cross-Genre Analysis and Composition Assessment	~15–20% of Q3	Modulation, popular/world-music styles, an original cross-genre composition
Q4 · Module 36	Capstone: Harmony and Composition Assessment	~20% of Q4	Comprehensive harmonic analysis + a chromatic-harmony composition
Q4 · Module 37	Theory II Year-End Portfolio	~25% of Q4	Curated portfolio of the year's work + a recorded reflective walkthrough + peer listening reply

2. Ungraded Interactives & the Intro/Outro Wrappers

Ungraded interactive activities (the flip cards, reflection prompts, and multiple-choice rows embedded in every lesson page) live on GitHub-deployed pages, give the student immediate feedback, and cost the teacher nothing — no submission is generated, and none needs grading. They are formation-by-practice, not busywork to chase down. A student who skips one shows up indirectly, in weaker quiz or discussion performance, not as a missing grade in your gradebook.

Intro/outro wrappers are Canvas Quizzes in survey mode, not wiki pages — this matters because it means every response is sortable cohort data, not just a completion checkbox. The intro wrapper (Tier 4, ungraded) captures the essential question, an objectives acknowledgment, and a confidence rating; the outro wrapper revisits the same essential question after the lesson, along with a revised confidence rating and often a look-ahead prompt tied to the next module's virtue thread (see Section 12).

Highest-leverage move in the whole course: spend 15–20 minutes per module triaging outro responses. Look for clusters of low confidence ratings or a repeated "still unclear" concept — that is your earliest signal of who needs help, well before a quiz score would show it. Respond with a targeted announcement, an Ignite-AI-drafted individual message, or a quick Canvas comment.

3. AI & VR in This Course (Student-Facing)

Gap found: a text search across all 37 lesson pages and every Canvas-native spec in both semesters turned up no AI-awareness callout of any kind — no "AI can/can't do this" box, no mention of AI tools, in any module. Other recent Optima builds (per house convention) place a short, factual AI-awareness callout in relevant lessons. This course currently has none. Until the course is revised to add them, there is nothing for you to point students to in-lesson; direct any AI-related conversation to the syllabus's "Appropriate Use of AI" section and the general school AI policy.

VR: this course has no VR component. Unlike Optima's VR-based electives, M/J Music Theory 2 is delivered entirely through Canvas and GitHub-hosted lesson pages; no headset, Location, or VR capture is required at any point in the 37 modules.

4. Using Ignite AI to Support Students (Teacher-Facing)

[VERIFY] before relying on this section: Ignite AI's exact feature set and availability depend on Optima's current Canvas release. Confirm what is actually enabled in your Canvas instance before promising a specific button to yourself or a co-teacher.

With ~500 On-Demand students per facilitator, Ignite AI (the Canvas AI assistant) is what makes individualized attention possible. Five functional uses, all governed by the coach-not-catch rule in Section 8 and one standing principle: **AI drafts, the teacher decides**. You always read, edit, and own anything before it reaches a student or family.

- **Drafting individualized feedback** on Tier 3 rubric items — faster turnaround, same human judgment, since you edit before posting.
- **Summarizing discussion threads and outro-wrapper analytics** to find a cohort's sticking points in minutes instead of an hour of manual reading.
- **Surfacing students who need a nudge** — low confidence on a recent outro, a missed quiz attempt, a quiet discussion presence — and drafting a warm check-in message you personalize before sending.
- **Generating extra practice variants** for a student who needs another rep on a Tier 1 skill (e.g., another set of Roman-numeral identification items after a rough Module 6 quiz attempt).
- **Communicating with families** — clear, kind progress summaries, translated when helpful.

5. Grading Categories & Canvas Gradebook Setup

The course's tier mix, read directly from every module's canvas-native spec, averages to the standard Optima 60/25/15 split. Set up four assignment groups:

Assignment group	Tier	Suggested weight	Grading method
Practice & Theory Checks	1	60%	Auto-graded, unlimited attempts
Discussions & Reflections	2	25%	Completion (rubric: substantive post + 1 reply = full credit)
Major Quarterly Assessments	3	15%	Native Canvas Rubric, 4 criteria (see Section 6)

Module Wrappers	4	0% (completion only, or excluded from grade)	Survey mode — mark complete/incomplete only
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Step-by-step: Grades → enable weighted groups → create the four groups above with those weights → on every wrapper quiz, set Quiz Type to *Ungraded Survey* so it never posts a grade → set late policy per the syllabus (10% deduction inside the final 14 days of a quarter, 0 after quarter close) → use the Module Progress / Requirements view as your at-a-glance completion signal for the mark-as-done lesson pages, since those never appear in the gradebook.

6. Rubrics for Every Teacher-Graded Item

All five major quarterly assessments (Section 1) share one 4-criteria rubric, each criterion scored 1–4, summed (range 4–16) and multiplied by 6.25 to produce a 100-point score. This is read directly from the build's own rubric tables (Modules 27, 36, 37) and should stay identical across every Tier 3 item so grading holds to roughly 5 minutes per student.

Criterion	4 – Strong	3	2	1 – Weak
Understanding	All or nearly all items correct; minor errors only	Most items correct; 1–2 consistent errors	Several errors; some core concepts present	Significant errors throughout; core concepts unclear
Reasoning	Specific, correct terminology, connects cause to effect	Correct but lacks specificity or technical precision	Vague or partially correct	Little to no explanatory reasoning; unsupported
Clarity	Clearly organized; all sections labeled and present	Mostly organized and labeled; minor gaps	Some organization; sections missing/incomplete	Disorganized; major sections missing
Intellectual Honesty	Genuine own work; any AI use disclosed per policy	Mostly genuine; minor undisclosed assistance	Some concerns about originality	Work is not genuinely the student's own

Scoring: 16 pts = 100, 12 pts = 75, 8 pts = 50, 4 pts = 25 (linear at 6.25/point). Paste this rubric into each Tier 3 Canvas assignment as a native Canvas Rubric so SpeedGrader totals it automatically.

Free-response items inside the auto-graded quizzes (e.g., Module 1's Question 10 note on the IAC cadence) include a short answer-guide alternative directly in the module's canvas-native.md — use the "Teacher key" line at the end of each quiz spec as your answer guide; these are not shown to students.

7. Discussions, Quizzes & Assessment Activities — How to Run & Grade

Type	How it's scored	Recommended teacher move
Auto-graded practice quiz (Tier 1)	Machine-graded, unlimited attempts	No action needed; scan the item analysis occasionally for a badly-worded question
Structured discussion (Tier 2)	Completion: substantive post + 1 reply = full credit; thin/partial = half; missing = 0	Batch-read in one sitting; drop 2–3 public model comments in the first 48 hours per module
Intro/outro wrapper survey (Tier 4)	Completion only, never a content grade	Triage for confidence clusters (see Section 2) — this is your early-warning system, not a grading task
Major quarterly assessment (Tier 3)	4-criteria rubric, 1–4 each (Section 6)	Grade in one sitting per quarter; expect ~10–15 min/student including feedback

Representative instances: Module 1's "Welcome to Theory II" discussion asks three questions (strongest skill, most excited topic, one genuine uncertainty) and one reply — full credit needs all three answered plus a real reply, not just "good post!". Module 17's Jazz-in-Context discussion asks students to explain the African-European rhythmic/harmonic synthesis using one specific era or style — a thin post naming no specific era earns half credit per that module's rubric note. Module 12's "Form Beyond Music" and Module 21's "Music and Its Sister Arts" (both added 2026-07-14) are interdisciplinary discussions: students identify a specific work of art or domain of knowledge outside music that shares a structural or cultural connection to that module's content, then defend or refine the connection with a classmate — full credit requires a **specific** named work or domain, not a vague "music connects to everything" post.

8. Coach, Not Catch

Your job is to move each student forward, not to detect and punish. In practice:

- Feedback names the next step, not just the error. Lead with what's working.
- Tier 1 practice allows unlimited re-attempts — it is a learning tool, not a trap.
- Use outro-wrapper analytics and Ignite AI to find students who need help early, then reach out — not to build a case against them.
- On suspected AI misuse or academic dishonesty: open a conversation first. Ask the student to talk through their thinking. Treat it as formation, not an accusation.
- Public discussion comments model good thinking; they never single out weak work for criticism.

9. Weekly Announcement Scripts

As the asynchronous facilitator's main presence, the weekly announcement matters. Template, then three drafted examples matched to this course's real cadence.

[Module N] template: "This week: [module topic]. The one thing not to miss: [due assessment / tricky concept]. If [specific confusion] came up in last week's outro wrapper, here's a quick tip: [one sentence]. You've got this, [house/class name] — see you in the discussion board."

Mid-module check-in (use when outro confidence runs low): "I noticed a few of you rated your confidence lower after [lesson topic] — that's completely normal for [specific skill, e.g., modal identification]. Before the quiz, try [one concrete tip]. Office hours are posted below if you want to talk it through."

Pre-major-assessment script: "The [Q_ assessment name] opens this week. It covers [2–3 named skills]. Best use of your practice time: [specific review pointer, e.g., 'redo the Module 9 modal-mixture quiz until you can explain each borrowed chord out loud']. Reach out before the due date, not after."

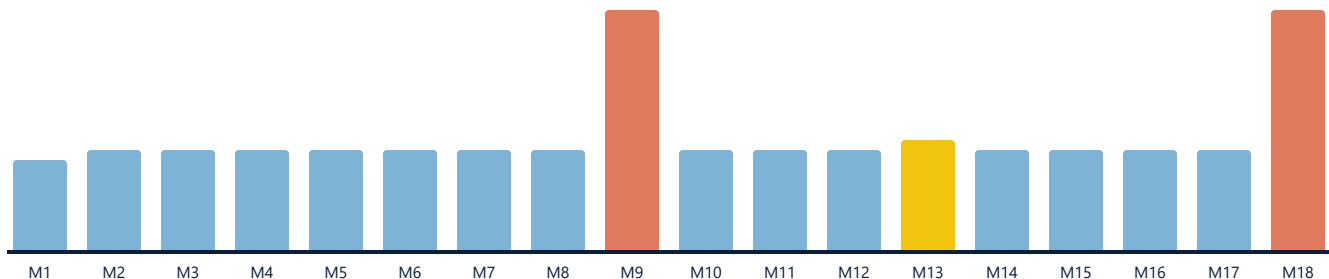
Re-engagement nudge (quiet students): "Haven't seen you in the discussion board this week — no judgment, just checking in. If something's stuck, a quick message gets you unstuck faster than working around it alone."

10. Teacher Workflow & Workload Map

A normal week: triage outro-wrapper analytics (15–20 min) → batch-grade discussions (20–30 min for ~500 students, spread across the week) → grade any due major assessment if the module has one (~10–15 min/student, only 5 of 37 weeks) → post the weekly announcement → answer Canvas messages as they arrive.

Heavy modules — budget extra time

Modules 9, 18, 27, 36, and 37 each carry a Tier 3 major assessment (or, for Module 37, a Tier 3 portfolio review) — plan your grading week around these five. Every other module holds to the light/standard 60/25/15 pattern with no extra facilitator load.



Semester 1 shown (Modules 1–18). Blue = standard week, gold = species-counterpoint week (M13, extra grading care for two-voice writing), coral = Tier 3 major-assessment week (M9, M18). Semester 2 follows the identical pattern with coral weeks at M27, M36, and M37 (portfolio review).

11. Standards Coverage Map (CPALMS → Modules)

Status after the 2026-07-14 corrective pass: 30 of 32 official standards now covered. The original audit found only 9 of 32 official CPALMS benchmarks covered anywhere in the course, 6 invalid/nonexistent codes cited repeatedly, and fabricated descriptions attached even to valid codes. A corrective pass — detailed below — closed 21 more codes by adding real content (required audio submissions, self-critique prompts, two interdisciplinary discussions, a new Module 37 reading block, aural-ID quiz items, a technology-history reading) rather than by relabeling alone. Two official codes remain genuinely open, and the pass did not touch every module, so some invalid codes and fabricated descriptions likely still exist outside the 14 modules listed below.

Officially valid codes now covered (30 of 32)

Code	Benchmark	Covered in modules
MU.68.O.1.1	Compare performances to identify artistic choices	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 12, 16, 24, 25
MU.68.O.2.1	Create a composition, manipulating musical elements and exploring the effects	30, 32 new
MU.68.O.3.1	Describe how instrumentation/expression convey thought, idea, mood, image	2, 3, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 14, 15, 18, 22, 27, 29, 31, 36
MU.68.O.3.2	Perform expressive elements from score/conductor; transfer to new works	13, 28, 30, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37 (now genuinely accurate — required audio recordings added)
MU.68.C.1.1	Develop strategies for listening to unfamiliar works	1, 11, 12, 15, 16, 24, 25, 31
MU.68.C.1.2	Compare a performance's aesthetic impact to a hypothesis of composer intent	16 new
MU.68.C.1.3	Identify, aurally, instrumental styles and ensembles	17, 19 new
MU.68.C.1.4	Identify, aurally, vocal styles and ensembles	17 new
MU.68.C.2.3	Critique own composition/improvisation with guidance, to generate improvements	30, 32, 34, 35 new
MU.68.C.3.1	Apply criteria to evaluate a work as exemplar of style/genre	21, 30, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37
MU.68.F.1.1	Create a composition using visual/kinesthetic/digital/acoustic means	30 new
MU.68.F.1.2	Create a composition reflecting traditional and contemporary technologies	32 new
MU.68.F.2.1	Describe routes a composition/performance travels creator to consumer	37
MU.68.F.2.2	Describe how concert attendance financially impacts a community	37 new
MU.68.F.3.1	Describe how studying music enhances citizenship, leadership, global thinking	37 new
MU.68.F.3.2	Investigate IP law; practice safe/legal/responsible use of musical media	37 new
MU.68.F.3.3	Identify compositional-process tasks and workplace application	37 new

MU.68.H.1.5	Classify compositional characteristics of a time period/genre using representative works	28 new
MU.68.H.2.1	Describe influence of historical events/periods on music	14, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 23, 24, 25
MU.68.H.2.2	Analyze how technology changed how music is created/performed/acquired/experienced	23 new
MU.68.H.2.3	Classify literature studied by genre, style, and/or time period	12 new
MU.68.H.3.1	Identify connections among music and other content areas/contexts (interdisciplinary)	12, 21 new
MU.68.S.1.2	Compose a short musical piece	30 new
MU.68.S.1.3	Arrange a short piece by manipulating melody/form/rhythm/voicing	32, 35 new
MU.68.S.1.4	Sing or play melodies by ear with support	26, 30, 32, 34, 35, 37
MU.68.S.1.5	Perform melodies with chord progressions	34, 35 new
MU.68.S.1.6	Compose a melody over a standard harmonic progression	34, 35 new
MU.68.S.1.8	Demonstrate mixing/editing techniques using software/hardware	30, 32, 34, 35, 36 new
MU.68.S.3.3	Sight-read standard exercises and simple repertoire	26 new
MU.68.S.3.4	Compare notation to aural examples for rhythm/pitch accuracy	26
MU.68.S.3.5	Notate rhythmic phrases/melodies performed by someone else	26 new

Still genuinely uncovered (2 of 32)

Code	Benchmark	Why it's still open
MU.68.O.2.2	Demonstrate knowledge of major and minor tonalities through performance and composition	Q1 (Modules 1-9) is built entirely around minor keys and modes and very plausibly already satisfies this, but Modules 1-9 were outside this corrective pass's scope. Likely the single fastest remaining fix — someone should check whether Module 9's Q1 Tier-3 assessment (which already requires a 4-measure SATB harmonization in a minor key) can simply be credited with this code.

— Every other official code is now covered at least once.

What the corrective pass actually did (2026-07-14)

- **Required audio submissions** added to every composition module (30, 32, 34, 35) and Module 36's capstone Part B — previously "a MuseScore playback... if you cannot record live" was optional language; now an audio file (live or MuseScore-exported) is a required deliverable alongside a required Mixer step (View > Mixer: balance, instrument sound, or tempo). This single change is what makes MU.68.O.3.2 and MU.68.S.1.8 genuinely accurate across five modules, not just technically cited.

- **Required self-critique** added to every composer statement in Modules 30, 32, 34, 35 — closes MU.68.C.2.3.
- **Module 26 now actually includes singing** — a required Part C sight-singing recording closes MU.68.S.3.3 and strengthens MU.68.S.1.4 for a module literally titled "Sight-Singing" that previously had none.
- **Two Tier-2 discussions rewritten as interdisciplinary forums**, same slot, no new grading load: Module 12 ("Form Beyond Music" — sonata form's departure/tension/return structure vs. architecture, rhetoric, literature, or another field of the student's choosing) and Module 21 ("Music and Its Sister Arts" — a raga/maqam/gamelan tradition paired with another work of art or domain from the same culture). Both require students to identify the connection, describe it specifically, and reply to a classmate's finding. Closes MU.68.H.3.1.
- **New Module 37 reading + reflection, "Music in the World: Industry, Citizenship, and Law"** — closes the entire F.2.2/F.3.1/F.3.2/F.3.3 cluster in one Tier-1 addition, covering concert economics, music and citizenship, copyright/IP law (tied directly to the course's own link-out-vs-embed practice), and music-industry careers.
- **Aural-identification quiz items** added to Module 17 (jazz combo vs. big band vs. vocalist, 3 items) and Module 19 (solo Delta blues vs. full electric band, 2 items) — closes MU.68.C.1.3/C.1.4. **Action needed:** the facilitator must post the actual linked recordings in these quiz questions before publishing; the specs name the type of recording needed but do not hardcode a URL.
- **Module 16's essay gained a "Performance Comparison" section** comparing a real recorded performance to the student's own analysis-based hypothesis of the piece's expressive character — closes MU.68.C.1.2.
- **Module 23 gained a short reading + reflection on recording technology's effect on music** (phonograph through streaming) — closes MU.68.H.2.2.
- **Invalid codes corrected to real CPALMS equivalents** in every module this pass touched (12, 16, 17, 19, 21, 23, 26, 28, 30, 32, 34, 35, 36, 37).

Scope note: this pass deliberately touched 14 of 37 modules — the ones where a genuine standards gap could be closed with real content, not just a relabel. Modules not listed above (most of 1-11, 13-15, 18, 20, 22, 24-25, 27, 29, 31, 33) were not reviewed in this pass and may still carry invalid codes (the audit's original list: MU.68.S.1.1, MU.68.C.2.1, MU.68.H.1.1, MU.68.H.1.2, MU.68.S.3.1, MU.68.S.2.1) with fabricated benchmark descriptions. A full module-by-module pass across the remaining 23 modules is the recommended next step, along with the one-line fix for MU.68.O.2.2 noted above.

12. What Makes This Course Classical & Cultivating Culture

What makes it classical: the course treats music theory itself as a discipline within the Great Conversation — students read Open Music Theory alongside real repertoire spanning Bach fugues, jazz standards, folk/rock modal schemas, and 20th-century works, rather than a worksheet-only approach to notation. The Module 37 Year-End Portfolio asks students to defend their own analytical and compositional choices aloud, a small disputatio moment built into the capstone. The virtue thread is genuinely present, not decorative: Module 18's outro wrapper names *courage* directly ("the willingness to attempt complex

harmonic analysis even when it feels unfamiliar") and ties it to that module's actual content, and other modules' outro prompts follow the same pattern of naming a virtue and asking students to locate it in their own week's struggle.

Cultivating culture asynchronously: drop 2–3 public model discussion comments per module in the first 48 hours, naming specific student thinking rather than generic praise. Use the weekly announcement to model curiosity about the week's content, not just logistics. Treat the outro-wrapper triage (Section 2) as a relationship practice, not an admin task — a well-timed individual message after a low-confidence rating is what a real teacher does in a physical classroom.

13. Sensitive-Content Flags

No sensitive content was identified anywhere in the 37-module course. A targeted search for mature themes, historically difficult material (e.g., segregation-era context in the jazz history modules), and other flagged topics turned up nothing requiring a family/student advance notice. Jazz history content (Modules 17, 19, 34, 35) is treated at the level of musical style and form, not social history, so no advance script is needed. If a future revision adds deeper historical context to the jazz units, revisit this section.